6431 Michels Drive
Washington, MO 63090
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Supplier Approval & Monitoring Procedure

Purpose
This procedure defines the process used by Wildwood Ingredients, LLC to approve, monitor, and re-evaluate suppliers that provide ingredients, packaging materials, or services that impact product quality and safety. The procedure ensures compliance with FSMA and BRCGS Global Standard for Food Safety requirements.

Definitions
Approved Supplier List (ASL): Controlled record of all approved ingredient and packaging suppliers.

High-Risk Supplier: Provides materials with direct food contact or known elevated risk (e.g., foreign origin, allergens, chemical hazards).

Medium-Risk Supplier: Provides food-contact packaging or low-hazard ingredients.

Low-Risk Supplier: Provides non-food-contact items or services with minimal impact on food safety.

Exception Purchase: Temporary authorization to buy from a non-approved supplier under controlled conditions, approved by the Director of Operations.

Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Director of Operations	Conducts supplier risk assessment, approves suppliers, reviews supporting documentation, authorizes exceptions, and ensures periodic review.
Quality Assurance (QA)	Maintains supplier files, ensures ASL accuracy, reviews CoAs, and tracks performance.
President	Ensures purchasing follows this procedure and verifies documentation before orders are placed.

Supplier Approval Workflow

Supplier Identified
↓
Supplier Documentation Request (Form 3.5-02) sent to supplier
↓
Documents received → Supplier Quality Survey (Form 3.5-03) completed
↓
Risk Assessment (based on product type, origin, and historical performance)
↓
Documentation Review (audit cert, FSMA/BRC statements, specs, SDS)
↓

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Director of Operations Approval → Added to Approved Supplier List (Doc 3.5.1.1 – 03)
↓
Approved for Purchase

Exception Path:
Urgent Need / Supply Chain Disruption
↓
Temporary Purchase Request submitted to Director of Operations
↓
Risk justification completed & documented
↓
Approval granted by Director of Operations
↓
Product testing/inspection required prior to release
↓
Post-purchase review → decision on supplier continuation

Supplier Risk Assessment Matrix:

Risk Level	Examples	Approval Requirements	Review Frequency
Tier 1	Imported ingredients, flavorings, colorants, preservatives	3rd-party audit certificate, supplier survey, full documentation packet (specs, SDS, COA, allergen, food defense, FSMA/BRC statements)	Annual
Tier 2	Domestic ingredients, primary packaging	Supplier survey, audit certificate or regulatory registration, documentation packet (specs, SDS, COA)	Every 2 years
Tier 3	Secondary packaging, service providers	Audit certificate or signed letter of guarantee, limited documentation (COA if applicable)	Every 3 years

Documentation Requirements by Risk Level

Document	Tier 1	Tier 2	Tier 3
Supplier Questionnaire (3.5-03)	✓	Preferred	Optional
Third-Party Audit Certificate	✓	✓	Optional

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FSMA / BRC Statement	✓	✓ (optional if GFSI certificate received)	Optional
Product Specifications	✓	✓	N/A
Safety Data Sheet (SDS)	✓	✓	N/A
Allergen Statement	✓	✓	N/A
Certificate of Analysis (per lot)	✓	✓	As applicable
Food Defense / Recall Statements	✓	✓(optional if GFSI certificate received)	N/A
Packaging Statement (if applicable)	✓	✓	✓
Halal / Kosher / GMO / BE Statements	As applicable	As applicable	N/A

Monitoring & Re-evaluation

Supplier performance is tracked through CoA compliance, nonconformances, and responsiveness. Suppliers with repeated quality issues are reclassified as higher risk. The Director of Operations reviews supplier status annually during Management Review. Changes in ownership, facility, or certification trigger re-evaluation.

Purchasing from Non-Approved Suppliers (Controlled Exception)

Only the Director of Operations may authorize purchase from a non-approved supplier. A Temporary Supplier Exception Form (3.5.1.1 – 04) shall document:

- Justification for purchase (e.g., supply chain disruption)
- Risk assessment summary
- Temporary approval duration (max 6 months)
- Verification required (lot-specific COA, testing, or inspection results)

The supplier must be fully approved or removed following post-purchase evaluation.

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